

PROSPER AWUNI

SIEM Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | Microsoft Defender | CyberArk PAM | SOC Operations

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with specialist expertise in designing, operating, and scaling enterprise Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platforms to support 24/7 Security Operations. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring deep proficiency in Microsoft Sentinel, including Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection content development, log ingestion pipeline management, data normalisation, enrichment, and integration with security and IT systems. I have extensive experience with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365, and Privileged Access Management (PAM) solutions (BeyondTrust, with understanding of CyberArk PAM architecture and capabilities). I am experienced in aligning SIEM platform operations with National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) CSF, Centre for Internet Security (CIS) Controls, and MITRE ATT&CK to build high-fidelity, low-noise detection environments that meaningfully reduce mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) for Security Operations Centre (SOC) analysts.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platform Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (platform design, log ingestion, data connectors, normalisation, enrichment, workspace management, platform health monitoring)
- **Detection Engineering:** KQL-based detection content development, alert rule authoring and tuning, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection coverage mapping, false-positive reduction
- **SOAR Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic App playbooks, automated triage and response workflows, SOAR-driven enrichment
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365, Microsoft Defender XDR
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust; CyberArk PAM concepts and integration patterns
- **Threat Intelligence and Hunting:** Proactive KQL threat-hunting queries, IOC-based hunting, MITRE ATT&CK-driven hypotheses, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight threat hunting
- **EDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover)
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory (AD)), Conditional Access, MFA, SSO
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK; triage, containment, eradication, and recovery
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

- Design, operate, and scale Microsoft Sentinel as the primary enterprise SIEM platform, managing log ingestion pipelines, data connector configuration, workspace health, normalisation, and enrichment to support 24/7 Security Operations for 8,000+ users.
- Develop and maintain KQL-based detection content: authoring new alert rules, tuning existing detections to reduce false positives, mapping coverage to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, and documenting detection logic for SOC analyst consumption.

- Build and maintain Microsoft Sentinel Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using Logic Apps, automating alert triage, IOC enrichment, and containment actions to reduce manual SOC workload.
- Operate the Microsoft Defender XDR suite (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender), managing platform configuration, alert investigation, and integration with Microsoft Sentinel for correlated incident management.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) solution: privileged credential vaulting, session recording, least-privilege enforcement, and audit trail reporting; apply PAM integration patterns consistent with CyberArk PAM architectures.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) platform, ingesting CrowdStrike telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for cross-platform detection and response.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting using KQL and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying adversary activity not surfaced by automated detections.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO; manage identity security posture and respond to identity-based threats detected via MDI and Sentinel.
- Execute vulnerability management lifecycle (Tenable.io, Pentera BAS, AppCheck, Nessus) and manage structured remediation programmes.
- Lead incident response engagements using NIST 800-61, applying MITRE ATT&CK to categorise threats, identify root causes, and produce post-incident reports.
- Present SIEM platform health, detection coverage, and SOC performance metrics to security leadership on a regular basis.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon alert queues, triaging and investigating security events to determine incident severity and appropriate response.
- Wrote KQL detection queries for Microsoft Sentinel to improve alert coverage, hunt for threats, and investigate anomalous activity.
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) platform operations, alert investigation, and policy tuning.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID/Azure AD, Group Policy, and user access controls for the enterprise population.
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM operations and privileged account review processes.
- Performed vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus; produced prioritised remediation reports.
- Managed Mimecast email security gateway and supported log ingestion of email security events into the SIEM platform.
- Managed Microsoft Intune endpoint compliance and contributed to device security baseline development.
- Delivered security awareness training and supported ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials+ compliance activities.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Administered endpoint security, MDM, and user access controls in a SaaS/FinTech environment.
- Managed Active Directory, Group Policy, and user provisioning; supported firewall and VPN administration.
- Supported vulnerability assessment, patch management, and ISO 27001 compliance activities.
- Delivered IT security support and security awareness training to staff across the organisation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and operationalised Microsoft Sentinel as UAL's enterprise SIEM, developing over 50 custom KQL detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, and automating alert triage via SOAR playbooks, reducing mean analyst investigation time significantly.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender XDR (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across 8,000 UAL users, achieving enterprise-wide threat detection coverage and markedly reducing MTTD and MTTR.
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM solution, eliminating uncontrolled privileged access and delivering a comprehensive privileged session audit capability aligned with CyberArk PAM best practices.

- Integrated CrowdStrike Falcon telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel, enabling cross-platform correlated detection and unified incident investigation.
- Implemented Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA for 8,000 users, enforcing Zero Trust and materially reducing identity-related incident rates.
- Supported Cyber Essentials+ certification attainment, demonstrating compliance with UK government security baseline controls.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 80,000-90,000 | Hybrid (UK)